

SAMKHYA (SĀṂKHYA)

DUALIST ARCHITECTURE → KNOWLEDGE AND PROOF OF → THREE QUALITIES (GUṆAS) → TWENTY-FIVE PRINCIPLES (TATTVAS) → PRE-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT → WHY MANY CONSCIOUS WITNESS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g13 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

DUALIST ARCHITECTURE

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PRE-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT IN THE CAUSE (SATKĀRYAVĀDA) +

(TATTVA) EVOLUTION + PLURAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS (PURUṢAS)

PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI) CONSCIOUS WITNESS (PURUṢA) ONE, UNCONSCIOUS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SĀṂKHYA = PRE-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT IN THE CAUSE (satkāryavāda) + CONSTITUTIVE PRINCIPLE
- (tattva) EVOLUTION + PLURAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣas)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (prakṛti) CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣa) one, unconscious, productive many, conscious, inactive witnesses unmanifest nature (avyakta) equilibrium
- discrimination ends bondage.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- SĀṂKHYA = PRE-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT IN THE CAUSE (satkāryavāda) + CONSTITUTIVE PRINCIPLE
- (tattva) EVOLUTION + PLURAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣas)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sāṃkhya is a realist dualism of one unconscious material nature and many non-objectifiable conscious witnesses.

01

STAGE 01

KNOWLEDGE AND PROOF OF PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI)

KNOWLEDGE AND PROOF OF PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI)

THREE MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀṆAS)

RELIABLE TESTIMONY PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI) IS INFERRED, NOT

EFFECTS SHARE COMMON FEATURES COORDINATED WORLD REQUIRES COMMON SOURCE

EVOLUTES NEED AN UNEVOLVED GROUND PLEASURE/PAIN/DULLNESS IN EFFECTS

SATTVA/RAJAS/TAMAS IN CAUSE

PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI)

BEGINNINGLESS, UNMANIFEST, INDEPENDENT MATERIAL CAUSE

THREE MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇas): perception

reliable testimony primordial material nature (prakṛti) is inferred, not ordinarily perceived finite effects require cause

common features coordinated world requires common source → evolutes need an unevolved ground pleasure/pain/dullness in

in cause

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- THREE MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇas): perception
- reliable testimony primordial material nature (prakṛti) is inferred, not ordinarily perceived finite effects require cause → effects share

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- common features coordinated world requires common source → evolutes need an unevolved ground pleasure/pain/dullness in effects → sattva/rajas/tamas
- in cause

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (prakṛti): beginningless, unmanifest, independent material cause
- not "matter" alone, but psychophysical source of intellect, senses and elements.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Prakṛti is inferred as the unmanifest common cause whose three-guṇa structure explains the coordinated diversity of mind and world.

02

STAGE 02

THREE QUALITIES (GUṆAS)

THREE QUALITIES (GUṆAS)

SATTVA LIGHTNESS

PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI) EQUILIBRIUM BREAKS

RAJAS ----- TAMAS ACTIVITY

PAIN INERTIA

DULLNESS QUALITIES (GUṆAS) ARE CONSTITUENTS, NOT DETACHABLE QUALITIES MUTUAL

SATTVA lightness

PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (prakṛti) equilibrium breaks

RAJAS ----- TAMAS activity

pain inertia

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SATTVA lightness
- PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (prakṛti) equilibrium breaks

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- RAJAS ----- TAMAS activity
- pain inertia

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- dullness qualities (guṇas) are constituents, not detachable qualities mutual domination + support + production drive all manifest difference.
- SATTVA lightness

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The guṇas are dynamic constituents of prakṛti, not detachable qualities; their changing proportions generate every psychophysical state.

03

STAGE 03

TWENTY-FIVE PRINCIPLES (TATTVAS)

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PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI) (1)

COSMIC INTELLECT (MAHAṬ)

DETERMINATIVE INTELLECT (BUDDHI) (2)

EGO-MAKER (AHAṂKĀRA) (3)

SENSORY MIND (MANAS) (4) + 5 JÑĀNENDRIYAS + 5

5 SUBTLE ELEMENT (TANMĀTRAS)

5 GROSS ELEMENT (MAHĀBHŪTAS)

- SATTVA lightness
- PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (prakṛti) equilibrium breaks

- KĀJAS ----- TAMAS activity
- pain inertia

- dullness qualities (guṇas) are constituents, not detachable qualities mutual domination + support + production drive all manifest difference.
- SATTVA lightness

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5 GROSS ELEMENT (MAHĀBHŪTAS)

PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (prakṛti) (1)

COSMIC INTELLECT (mahat) / DETERMINATIVE INTELLECT (buddhi) (2)

EGO-MAKER (ahaṇkāra) (3)

sāttvika → SENSORY MIND (manas) (4) + 5 JÑĀNENDRIYAS + 5 KARMENDRIYAS

tāmasa → 5 SUBTLE ELEMENT (tanmātras) → 5 GROSS ELEMENT (mahābhūtas)

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (prakṛti) (1)

COSMIC INTELLECT (mahat) / DETERMINATIVE INTELLECT (buddhi) (2)

EGO-MAKER (ahaṇkāra) (3)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

sāttvika → SENSORY MIND (manas) (4) + 5 JÑĀNENDRIYAS + 5 KARMENDRIYAS

tāmasa → 5 SUBTLE ELEMENT (tanmātras) → 5 GROSS ELEMENT (mahābhūtas)

rājasa supplies activity to both branches

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣa) (25) stands outside the evolute chain as witness

COUNT CONTROL: 1 primordial material nature (prakṛti) + 23 evolutes + conscious witness (puruṣa) = 25 principles (tattvas).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CORE ARGUMENT): “Pre-existence of the effect in the cause (satkāryavāda) (the theory that the effect pre-exists potentially in its cause) and real transformation (pariṇāmavāda) make the evolution of twenty-five fundamental principles a manifestation of determinate causal powers rather than creation from non-being.”.

04

STAGE 04

PRE-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT IN THE CAUSE (SATKĀRYAVĀDA)

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EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE ASADAKARAṆĀṬ

NON-BEING CANNOT BE PRODUCED UPĀDĀNAGRAHAṆĀṬ

SPECIFIC MATERIAL CAUSE IS SELECTED SARVASAMBHAVĀBHĀVĀṬ

NOT EVERYTHING ARISES FROM EVERYTHING ŚAKTASYA ŚĀKYAKARAṆĀṬ

CAUSE PRODUCES ONLY WHAT IT HAS POWER TO PRODUCE

EFFECT SHARES NATURE OF CAUSE REAL TRANSFORMATION (PARIṆĀMAVĀDA)

REAL TRANSFORMATION OF PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI)

EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE asadakaraṇāt: non-being cannot be produced upādānagrahaṇāt: specific material cause is

everything arises from everything śaktasya śākyakaraṇāt: cause produces only what it has power to produce

nature of cause real transformation (pariṇāmavāda): real transformation of primordial material nature (prakṛti)

NYĀYA new production (ārambhavāda): new effect

ADVAITA vivarta: apparent transformation.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE asadakaraṇāt: non-being cannot be produced upādānagrahaṇāt: specific material cause is selected sarvasambhavābhāvāt: not

everything arises from everything śaktasya śākyakaraṇāt: cause produces only what it has power to produce kāraṇabhāvāt: effect shares

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

nature of cause real transformation (pariṇāmavāda): real transformation of primordial material nature (prakṛti)

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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ADVAITA vivarta: apparent transformation.

EFFECT PRE-EXISTS LATENTLY IN CAUSE asadakaraṇāt: non-being cannot be produced upādānagrahaṇāt: specific material cause is selected sarvasambhavābhāvāt: not

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (FINAL VERDICT): “The power of Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) lies in connecting epistemology, material continuity, empirical consciousness and liberation within one system; its weakness is that the relation required to connect its two absolutes remains under-explained.”.

05

STAGE 05

WHY MANY CONSCIOUS WITNESS (PURUṢAS)?

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CONSCIOUS WITNESS (PURUṢA) EXISTS BECAUSE COMPOSITES SERVE ANOTHER

EXPERIENCE NEEDS CONSCIOUS WITNESS OBJECTS OF THREE QUALITIES (GUṆAS)

LIBERATION IS CONCEIVABLE

BIRTHS/DEATHS DIFFER; SENSE CAPACITIES AND ACTIONS ARE UNCOORDINATED

IF ONE CONSCIOUS WITNESS (PURUṢA), ONE PERSON'S LIBERATION OR

CONTACT PROBLEM

INACTIVE CONSCIOUSNESS CANNOT LITERALLY TOUCH UNCONSCIOUS PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE

CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣa) EXISTS BECAUSE composites serve another

experience needs conscious witness objects of three qualities (guṇas) require non-guṇa experiencer

liberation is conceivable

PLURALITY: births/deaths differ; sense capacities and actions are uncoordinated

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

CONSCIOUS WITNESS (puruṣa) EXISTS BECAUSE composites serve another

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liberation is conceivable

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

PLURALITY: births/deaths differ; sense capacities and actions are uncoordinated

if one conscious witness (puruṣa), one person's liberation or pain would belong to all

CONTACT PROBLEM: inactive consciousness cannot literally touch unconscious primordial material nature (prakṛti) analogies: blind-and-lame cooperation

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

magnet and iron pressure remains: how does mere proximity begin purposive evolution?

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CRITICISM): “Sāṃkhya (the enumerative dualist school) integrates psychology, cosmology and liberation without a creator God, yet guṇa-explanation risks elasticity, Puruṣa-plurality lacks a clear individuator, and mere proximity does not fully solve the contact problem.”.

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liberation is conceivable

interaction is conceivable

contact problem: births/deaths differ, sense capacities and actions are uncoordinated

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06

STAGE 06

BONDAGE, LIBERATION AND CRITIQUE

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DETERMINATIVE INTELLECT (BUDDHI)'S STATES ARE APPROPRIATED AS "I" BY

REPEATED EMBODIMENT TATTVA-JÑĀNA

"I AM CONSCIOUS WITNESS (PURUṢA), NOT PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE

(PRAKṚTI) OR ITS EVOLUTES" PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI) HAS

CEASES ACTIVITY FOR THAT CONSCIOUS WITNESS

ISOLATION (KAIVALYA)

UNCONSCIOUS PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI) CANNOT ACT FOR AN

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

AVIVEKA: determinative intellect (buddhi)'s states are appropriated as "I" by reflected consciousness experience + karmic dispositions → repeated

embodiment tattva-jñāna / viveka-khyāti: "I am conscious witness (puruṣa), not primordial material nature

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

(prakṛti) or its evolutes" primordial material nature (prakṛti) has been seen → ceases activity for that conscious witness

(puruṣa) → ISOLATION (kaivalya)

REPLY / RESIDUAL

ŚAMKARA: unconscious primordial material nature (prakṛti) cannot act for an end; dualism cannot explain contact

ŚĀMKHYA REPLY: teleology is immanent, as milk flows for calf; no creator is needed.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (CRITICISM): "Isolation (kaivalya) (liberating isolation of consciousness) follows from discriminative knowledge (viveka-jñāna), but the system's hardest burden is explaining how inactive consciousness and unconscious nature can sustain coordinated, purposive experience."

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

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START WITH DUALISM AND THREE QUALITIES (GUṆAS)

PROVE PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI) AND PLURAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS

DRAW EXACT 25-TATTVA CASCADE

DEFEND PRE-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT IN THE CAUSE

(SATKĀRYAVĀDA) WITH FIVE REASONS

DISTINGUISH REAL TRANSFORMATION (PARIṆĀMAVĀDA) FROM ĀRAMBHA/VIVARTA

EXPLAIN AVIVEKA AND ISOLATION (KAIVALYA)

START with dualism and three qualities (guṇas) → prove primordial material nature (prakṛti) and plural

draw exact 25-tattva cascade → defend pre-existence of the effect in the cause

(satkāryavāda) with five reasons

distinguish real transformation (pariṇāmavāda) from ārambha/vivarta

explain aviveka and isolation (kaivalya) → test contact and teleology objections

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

START with dualism and three qualities (guṇas) → prove primordial material nature (prakṛti) and plural conscious witness (puruṣas)

draw exact 25-tattva cascade → defend pre-existence of the effect in the cause

(satkāryavāda) with five reasons

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

distinguish real transformation (pariṇāmavāda) from ārambha/vivarta

explain aviveka and isolation (kaivalya) → test contact and teleology objections

QUALIFIED VERDICT: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

is its hard problem.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFIED VERDICT: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature is its hard problem.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sāṃkhya powerfully unifies cosmos, mind and liberation, but the coordination of inactive consciousness with unconscious nature is its hard problem.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY

IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED PROOF BURDEN AND COGNITION

ITS THREE ACCEPTED MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀNAS).

THIS ECONOMY CREATES A BURDEN

IMPERCEPTIBLE PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (PRAKṚTI) AND CONSCIOUS WITNESS (PURUṢA)

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

Layer-placement note

Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.

It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced proof burden and cognition model Sāṃkhya reduces comparison, postulation, non-apprehension and tradition to

ADVANCED OBJECTION

its three accepted means of valid knowledge (pramānas).

This economy creates a burden: imperceptible Primordial material nature (prakṛti) and Conscious witness (puruṣa) cannot simply be asserted.

Samanyato-drsta inference must reach entities never presented as ordinary sense-objects.

Carvaka attacks the unobserved universal relation, while Nyaya grants inference but proposes atoms and Lord (īśvara) as a more economical explanation.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

Sāṃkhya replies that material continuity, guṇa-patterns and the objectifiability of experience jointly require one material root and a

distinct witness.

Empirical cognition occurs through the inner instrument.

Sensory mind (manas) coordinates, ego-maker (ahaṃkāra) appropriates and determinative intellect (buddhi) determines.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.